

2026-05-31 - KXTJ3-1057 Accelerometer with CBOR Encoding over USB

Goal

Extend the KXTJ3-1057 driver from Day 15 to encode accelerometer readings as CBOR and transmit them over USB CDC-ACM. Add shell commands to control the output format and a Python script to receive, decode, and display the data on a PC.

What you will learn

- How to combine zcbor encoding with real sensor data
- How to design a simple binary protocol using CBOR maps
- How to trigger CBOR output from an interactive shell
- How to write a Python receiver to decode and display the sensor stream

CBOR frame format

Each transmission is a self-contained CBOR map:

```
{
  "seq":  <uint32>,    sequence number
  "x":    <int32>,     X-axis in mg
  "y":    <int32>,     Y-axis in mg
  "z":    <int32>,     Z-axis in mg
  "rng":  <uint8>      current range in g (2, 4, 8, or 16)
}
```

The frame is followed by a newline (0x0A) as a simple delimiter so the Python receiver can use `readline()` to receive complete packets.

Encoded size

A typical frame encodes to ~25–30 bytes — well within a single USB packet.

Shell commands

Command	Description
<code>accel whoami</code>	Verify WHO_AM_I register
<code>accel read</code>	Print one reading as plain text
<code>accel cbor</code>	Send one CBOR frame over USB

Command	Description
<code>accel stream <n></code>	Send n CBOR frames at 200 ms intervals
<code>accel range <g></code>	Set measurement range (2/4/8/16)

Python decoder (tools/decode_accel.py)

The script connects to the USB serial port, reads CBOR frames, and prints a formatted table. Optional `--plot` flag renders a live scrolling graph using matplotlib.

```
# Install dependencies
pip install pyserial cbor2 matplotlib

# Basic usage
python3 tools/decode_accel.py --port /dev/ttyACM0

# With live plot
python3 tools/decode_accel.py --port /dev/ttyACM0 --plot
```

Example output

SEQ	X (mg)	Y (mg)	Z (mg)	Range
0	-12	34	998	±2g
1	-13	33	997	±2g
2	-11	35	999	±2g

Why this matters

Sending structured binary data (CBOR) instead of plain text strings is essential for production firmware — it is compact, self-describing, and easy to parse on any platform. This pattern is used in CoAP, SenML, LwM2M, and Bluetooth GATT descriptors.

Practice tasks

1. Flash and run `accel cbor` — confirm the Python script decodes correctly.
2. Run `accel stream 50` and observe the live plot.
3. Shake the board and confirm all three axes respond.
4. Switch to `accel range 4` mid-stream and confirm the mg values change scale.

Example folder

See `src/2026-05-31_KXTJ3_CB0R_USB` for the complete firmware and Python decoder.

Next topic

Future topics: BLE peripheral advertising sensor data, MCUboot OTA updates, low-power sleep with sensor wake-on-motion.